

A. Experience Proposal & Justification

Opportunity Identified from Assignment 2

Our original Patterns of Time experience was a digital interactive story game where youths took on the role of a batik apprentice and made choices that shaped their journey while learning about batik and cultural preservation. Through developing the experience, we identified an opportunity to make the learning experience more immersive by moving beyond digital storytelling and allowing users to physically interact with the craft. While the original experience successfully used storytelling, choice and gamification to encourage engagement, the experience was primarily centred around the temporary campaign and had limited purpose for users once the story was completed. There was also no clear pathway for users to discover or purchase Heritage Bay products. This presented an opportunity to create an experience that could connect heritage learning, hands-on participation, artisan stories and Heritage Bay's products while giving the digital platform a longer-term purpose.

Proposed Experience

We propose evolving Patterns of Time into a physical-first phygital apprenticeship experience. Visitors take on the role of an apprentice and move through a series of physical stations where they discover batik patterns, learn about traditional tools and processes, hear stories from artisans and participate in hands-on activities. Users receive a digital Apprentice Card through the Heritage Bay app, which is scanned at each station to track their progress throughout the apprenticeship. The physical experience is supported and extended by the app. Users can scan QR codes to discover artisan stories, complete interactive activities, upload their own batik designs and see them brought to life through projection mapping. After completing the physical apprenticeship, users can continue exploring the original Patterns of Time story game, discover more artisan stories and browse or purchase Heritage Bay products either through the app or in person.

How the Proposal Builds Upon Insights from Assignment 2

The refined experience builds upon the strengths of our original concept rather than replacing it. Assignment 2 showed us that interactive storytelling, choice, gamification and personalisation could make heritage learning more engaging for younger audiences. We retained these elements through the Patterns of Time story game, progress tracking and interactive digital content, but repositioned them within a broader experience.

We also recognised that batik is a craft that can be better understood through active participation rather than digital consumption alone. The refined experience therefore introduces physical touchpoints where users can see, touch and learn about batik tools and processes before creating something of their own. This creates a stronger connection between the digital content and the physical craft.

Another key improvement is the role of the app. Rather than creating a temporary campaign-specific app with limited use after the experience ends, the app is positioned as a longer-term Heritage Bay platform. The campaign becomes one layer of the platform, while artisan stories and product discovery give users additional reasons to return. The addition of a product purchase pathway also creates a clearer connection between learning about batik and discovering the products and artisans represented by Heritage Bay.

Value for Heritage Bay and Its Users

For users, the experience provides a more engaging and meaningful way to learn about batik by allowing them to learn through doing. Instead of only reading about cultural heritage, they can discover the stories behind patterns, understand traditional tools and processes, interact with artisan stories and create their own designs. The combination of physical and digital touchpoints also allows users to continue their journey beyond the physical experience through stories, the Patterns of Time game and product exploration.

For Heritage Bay, the experience provides a stronger way to engage younger audiences while supporting its role in preserving and promoting Indonesian cultural heritage. By connecting artisan stories and cultural knowledge with hands-on participation, the experience can make batik more accessible and relevant to a younger generation. The integrated product pathway also allows users to naturally move from learning about the craft → understanding its value → discovering the products and artisans behind it.

Most importantly, the refined direction transforms Patterns of Time from a primarily temporary digital campaign into a longer-term phygital Heritage Bay experience. The physical apprenticeship creates an immersive entry point, while the app provides opportunities for continued storytelling, discovery and purchase beyond the initial visit. This creates value not only during the campaign, but also through an ongoing relationship between users, artisans and Heritage Bay.